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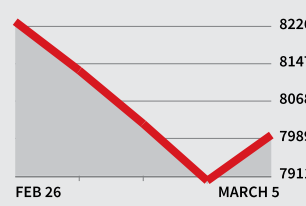
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Source
1. Kantar Report.
2. In an MMM meta-analysis we commissioned with Nielsen, on average, YouTube effectiveness was 24.11 times greater than Linear TV effectiveness across Total CPG MMMs that measured YouTube, Other Digital, and Linear TV from Jan'20- Sep'23 in India. According to a meta analysis of CPG MMM Studies by Analytic Edge in India, YouTube ROI was 3.0x of OTT Platforms ROI (2021-2024)

the hindu businessline

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Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	159943.00	-1954
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	264212.00	-7135

CHALLENGING PHASE.

The war in the Gulf poses serious energy challenges to India, says Arvind Panagariya, Chairman, Finance Commission **p3**



TIGHTER MARKET.

Platinum to remain in deficit for 4th straight year, though the shortfall may shrink by 75% **p8**

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QUICKLY.

FALLING FERTILITY

AP mulls incentives to raise birth rate



Hyderabad: The Andhra Pradesh government proposes to provide financial incentives to encourage couples to have more than one child as part of its new population management policy. The initiative is a first-of-its-kind effort by a State government to proactively address the falling fertility levels. **p9**

DE-ESCLATION HOPES

Sensex up 900 points on Iran's N-programme offer

Mumbai: Equity benchmarks staged a sharp recovery on Thursday, snapping a three-session losing streak, after reports that Iran had conditionally offered to abandon its nuclear programme raised hopes of de-escalation of the US/Israel-Iran conflict. The BSE Sensex surged 899.71 points, to close at 80,015.90, while the Nifty 50 gained 285.40 points, to settle at 24,765.90. **p6**

Enough LNG stocks now, but India will ration gas if disruption persists

AFTERSHOCK. Fertilizer industry and city gas distribution to get full supplies; govt monitoring LPG situation too

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India is currently “comfortable” with stocks of natural gas and the arrangements being made to procure LNG from Australia and Canada. However, if required, the government will “re-prioritise” allocation, with the fertilizer industry and city gas distribution (CGD) companies getting uninterrupted supplies.

The shutting down of liquefied natural gas (LNG) production by QatarEnergy has threatened 60 million standard cubic meters per day (MSCMD) of India's cumulative consumption of 195 MSCMD. India imports half its requirement of natural gas, of which 40-42 per cent comes from Qatar.

IN TALKS WITH IEA, OPEC Top government sources said that India is in touch with the International Energy Agency (IEA) and the OPEC on the West Asian scenario. It is also talking to the US, Australia and Canada for LNG supplies.



EXPLORING OPTIONS. A view of the IndianOil LNG terminal at Ennore in Chennai. India is also talking to the US, Australia and Canada for LNG supplies

“We are in a comfortable position currently on LNG and LPG. We are in touch with traders, such as Sonatrach Petroleum (Algeria), ADNOC, Trafigura and Vitol, as well as national oil companies (NoC) to purchase LNG and LPG,” said one of the sources.

PRIORITISING SUPPLIES On rationing of LNG supplies, another source said the situation is “comfortable” at present but supplies can be

“re-prioritised” if the Strait of Hormuz bottleneck persist. Meanwhile, GAIL announced that supplies from Qatar had come to a halt and it is assessing the need to curtail supplies to select customers. This comes after GAIL's long-term supplier Petronet LNG issued a *force majeure*.

“GAIL is currently assessing the situation with respect to any supply curtailment that may need to be imposed on its downstream

customers. Notwithstanding the above, LNG supplies to GAIL from other sources/suppliers are currently unaffected. At this stage, the potential impact of the ongoing *force majeure* situation cannot be quantified,” the PSU said in a BSE filing.

COOKING GAS

On LPG as well, the government is constantly reviewing the supply scenario. India imports more than half the LPG it consumes, with West Asia accounting for as much as 90 per cent of the total imports — most of which pass through the Strait of Hormuz.

“LPG from the US started coming to India from January. We are also buying from Norway. Besides, we have enough refining capacity, and with the crude supplies, refiners can produce more LPG. So, that is also an option,” explained a top source.

Sumit Ritolia, Kpler's Lead Research Analyst for Refining and Modelling, said that refineries can be pushed to maximise LPG yields, but refinery configurations and operational constraints

mean production cannot be ramped up meaningfully to compensate imports.

MARINE INSURANCE

Top government sources also said that India is talking to the US on its proposed mechanism for providing marine insurance for oil tankers and other product vessels crossing the 34 km-long world's most critical energy choke point.

“The Oil Secretary is in touch with US authorities on the matter of marine insurance. The discussions focused on issues such as insurance cover and the corpus amount to be created for the insurance,” said one of the sources.

In a March 3 statement, the US International Development Finance Corporation said it is ready to mobilise its Political Risk Insurance and Guaranty products to stabilise international commerce and support American and allied businesses operating in the West Asia during this period of conflict with the Iranian regime.

More reports p2

Services exports closing in on slowing goods shipments

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

With services exports growing briskly and merchandise export growth stagnating, the two are now converging. India's merchandise exports grew at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 1.2 per cent between FY22 and FY25. The slowdown is evident in FY26 as well. In contrast, services exports climbed sharply at a CAGR of 16 per cent in the period.

Services exports stand at \$348.4 billion in FY26 (April 2025-January 2026) as against merchandise exports of \$366.3 billion, and the gap between the two is narrowing. Merchandise exports have been pulled down by a fall in petroleum product shipments, while growth in services has been led by telecom and IT services.

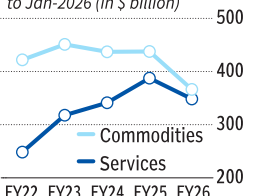
Services exports are driven largely by the technology and consulting sectors. Telecom, computer and information services exports grew from \$152.3 billion in FY23 to \$183.3 billion in FY25, a 9.7 per cent CAGR.

FUEL EXPORTS DOWN

In contrast, merchandise exports have been weighed down by a fall in petroleum shipments. Export of petroleum crude and related

Services and commodities exports converge

Total exports from April-2021 to Jan-2026 (in \$ billion)



Source: RBI *FY26 data are till Jan-end

products dropped from \$97.5 billion in FY23 to \$63.4 billion in FY25, a steep decline of 19.4 per cent in CAGR.

According to experts, the trend reflects India's deep talent pool in technology and business services.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at Bank of Baroda, said, “Demand for petrol products depends on growth in economies and the pace at which countries are turning to renewables. This, coupled with lower crude prices, accounts for the export performance.”

However, exports of other merchandise are growing. Electronics shipments surged from \$23.6 billion in FY23 to \$38.6 billion in FY25, and much of this has been driven by smartphone exports, particularly iPhones.

INSIDE.

West Asia-bound cargoes stuck at Kandla, JN ports

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

The movement of rice export consignments, LPG imports and bulk cargo, such as sulphur and gypsum, have been disrupted at the west coast ports — Deendayal Port in Gujarat and Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Maharashtra.

The escalating conflict in West Asia and the heightened security concerns across the Persian Gulf have delayed vessels, forced suspension of export gate-in activities, and left thousands of containers stranded at terminals.

Some 20,000 West Asia-bound boxes are stuck at the two ports, with a number of sailings postponed.

Read more p2

Estee Lauder fully acquires Forest Essentials

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

In a strategic move, Estee Lauder Companies Inc on Thursday said it is set to acquire the remaining stake in Ayurveda luxury beauty brand Forest Essentials.

The transaction to acquire the remaining 51 per cent stake is expected to close in H2 of calendar 2026. It had first acquired a minority stake in Forest Essentials in 2008 and increased it to 49 per cent in 2020. In a statement, Estee Lauder Companies Inc announced on Thursday that “it has entered into a pact, subject to regulatory approvals, to acquire the remaining interest in Forest Essentials”.

Details p3

Military force alone cannot fix issues, says Modi

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday called for dialogue and diplomacy to resolve conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine.

He said no issue can be settled solely through military force as India and Finland sought to deepen cooperation in technology, defence and sustainability during talks with Finnish President Alexander Stubb.

“India and Finland believe in the rule of law, dialogue and diplomacy. We are in agreement that no issue can be resolved solely through military conflict,” he said, referring to the tensions in West Asia and the war in Ukraine.

Read more p3

A prolonged war will hurt India: Raghuram Rajan

Vanitha Srinivasan
Chennai

A prolonged West Asia war could hurt India through higher oil prices, supply disruptions and weaker remittances, warned former RBI Governor Raghuram Rajan.

In an interview to *businessline*, he said: “I am hoping it's a short war lasting a week or so, when probably nothing serious will happen. We also have petroleum reserves, and so on, that can be released if need be. Obviously, it is a serious disruption, especially if other oilfields are shut... I am also worried about our citizens living in those areas. If those economies get more troubled, remittance is going to be hit.”

Interview p10

Costlier credit signals end of repo rate cut transmission to lending, deposit rates

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

The transmission of repo rate cuts to lending and deposit rates may be over, as interest rates on fresh loans went up even as interest rates on fresh deposits barely came down, going by RBI data for January.

This development comes as deposit growth (at 12.42 per cent year-on-year) lagged credit expansion (14.40 per cent) as on January 31.

That the transmission of the repo rate cuts into lending rates may have concluded can be gauged from the fact that the weighted average lending rate (WALR) on fresh rupee loans of scheduled commercial banks (SCBs) rose 39 bps to 8.67 per cent in January from 8.28 per cent in December 2025. The WALR had declined by



The weighted average lending rate on fresh rupee loans of banks rose 39 bps to 8.67% in January 2026 from 8.28% in December 2025

43 bps in December from 8.71 per cent in November.

REPO RATE

The Reserve Bank of India's rate-setting Monetary Policy Committee cumulatively reduced the repo rate by 125 basis points (bps) during the February-December 2025 period from 6.50 per cent to 5.25 per cent.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, observed that banks may be upping the spreads on fresh loans linked to external benchmarks such as the repo rate, resulting in an increase

in the WALR of these loans. External benchmark-linked loans, such as retail and MSME loans, account for almost 60 per cent of banks' overall loans.

He said: “There's a limit to which banks can keep lowering the interest rates... Yield of the 10-year benchmark Government Security is fairly intransigent in the 6.65-6.70 per cent range. And the fact that banks are now no longer able to pass on repo rate cuts as they're losing deposits itself shows that the transmission is over.”

The one-year median mar-

ginal cost of funds-based lending rate (MCLR) of SCBs increased to 8.45 per cent in February (back to the December level) from 8.40 per cent in January, per RBI data on lending and deposit rates. The weighted average domestic term deposit rate on fresh rupee term deposits of SCBs just about nudged down to 5.66 per cent in January (5.67 per cent in December).

V Rama Chandra Reddy, Head of Treasury, Karur Vysya Bank, said: “I think, the lending rates have bottomed out... Banks are either increasing spreads on fresh floating rate loans or giving more fixed rate loans.”

Sabnavis said that banks are raising short-term bulk deposits to offset the relatively slower growth in retail deposits (compared to loan growth). And this explains why the deposit rates are sticky.

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Reforms vindicated

Uptick in GST collections, a welcome trend shift

The revival in GST revenue growth in February (8.1 and 7.9 per cent, in gross and net terms, respectively) indicates that consumption demand is responding well to the tax cuts in September. The upturn comes after four indifferent months; growth in net GST collections was flat in October, and negative in November and December, and mildly positive in January (2.8 per cent). Last month’s collection seems like a trend-breaker, where the lower rates have been offset by demand. The Budget has pencilled in a 2.6 per cent drop in collections in FY27.



GST collections could better expectations, unless prolonged global headwinds act as a serious drag on the economy. Significantly, gross domestic GST revenue recorded 5.3 per cent growth in February, the rest of the growth coming from imports. Growth in auto sales including two-wheelers, three-wheelers, commercial and passenger vehicles were at a record high of 25.6 per cent in February. Other high frequency indicators — such as improvement in bank credit growth, higher e-way bills generation and PMI Manufacturing hitting a four-month high in February — too point towards good domestic demand.

Notwithstanding this positive all-India performance, there are inter-State variations. States with a large services segment have shown a stronger uptick in February. For instance, Karnataka recorded 11 per cent growth in SGST revenue, probably led by consumption by services sector employees. Similarly, Telangana has also reported 12 per cent growth in SGST collection. But States such as Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh continue to witness contraction in SGST revenue. While these variations are yet to be fully understood — it could be due to seasonal factors, statistical anomalies, or consumption patterns specific to a State — they could well change over time.

The Centre should now focus on other aspects, such as improving compliance and the technical infrastructure. GST has ushered in enterprise formalisation; the GST taxpayer base has increased from 60 lakh in 2017 to 1.5 crore in April 2025. Small businesses are jumping on to the GST bandwagon. Formalisation has picked up, but the informal economy is still estimated at about 45 per cent of GVA. GST must be reformed as a process that encourages on-boarding, through simplified registrations, tax return filings, input tax credit claims, fewer anomalies in the interpretation of provisions and an efficient refunds process. GST tribunals should play a facilitating role here. The tax authorities should not veer towards excesses in the pursuit of targets, more so where micro-enterprises are involved. A case in point is the booking of tea vendors in Karnataka last year on the basis of their UPI transactions. The pursuit of reforms, such as tax cuts, should be accompanied by ease of compliance for all businesses.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



Informal sector growth holds up

DATA POINTS. The new national accounts series shows that the informal sector has grown robustly in recent times



The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the new series of National Accounts with 2022-23 as its base on February 27, 2026. The new series has been introduced to address the concerns of quality of data and of a dated base.

The MoSPI informs that the new series improves compilation of private corporate institutional sector data by segregating activities in multi-activity enterprises. It also improves coverage of the unincorporated sector using annual survey data. It uses double deflation in the agriculture and manufacturing sectors and single extrapolation in the remaining sectors.

It incorporates updated rates and ratios from recent studies, extensively uses GST/new administrative data sources and synchronises production and expenditure side estimates better by integrating with Supply and Use Table (SUT) framework.

The new series uses 2022-23 as the base. It neutralises the impact of demonetisation, all India GST rollout and the pandemic, each of which overshadowed the growth, more particularly of the informal and MSME sectors. The GDP estimates based on the new series are, however, reasonably aligned to the old series.

Overall GDP in 2022-23 (the base year) at ₹23,761,232 crore is 96.4 per cent of the old series GDP at current prices. The ratio of new series to old series for other macro parameters is as follows: private final consumption expenditure, 90.3 per cent; gross value added, 96.4 per cent; and gross fixed capital formation, 96.4 per cent. Overall GDP growth at current prices for the new series during 2023-24, 2024-25 and 2025-26 are estimated at 11 per cent, 9.7 per cent and 8.6 per cent, respectively.

NO SURPRISES

The new GDCF/GDP ratio for 2023-24, 2024-25 and 2025-26 is estimated at 31.9 per cent, 31.6 per cent and 31.7 per cent, respectively. The new GDP series hardly surprises. With the incorporation of new data, one expected an increase in the value of the macro aggregates. However, they happen to be lower than the old estimates.



GOVARTHAN

Overall economy and informal sector (in ₹ cr)

Overall economy	New Series 2022-23 base			Old Series 2011-12 base	
	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2022-23	2023-24
Gross Value Added	23,763,761	26,316,103	28,854,467	24,646,698	27,412,888
Gross Savings	7,772,917	9,517,450	11,113,324	8,244,048	9,259,186
Gross Capital Formation	8,626,876	9,624,575	10,447,228	8,695,888	9,624,795
Informal sector					
Gross Value Added	10,694,985	12,078,453	13,250,480	10,911,414	11,848,489
Gross Savings	5,225,437	5,963,550	6,900,602	5,010,475	5,461,259
Gross Capital Formation	3,674,635	4,094,766	4,425,126	3,614,851	3,844,515
Share of informal sector in overall macro parameters (per cent)					
Gross Value Added	45.0	45.9	45.9	44.3	43.2
Gross Savings	67.2	62.7	62.1	60.8	59.0
Gross Capital Formation	42.6	42.5	42.4	41.6	39.9

The availability of new data sets, new rates and ratios and quality enhancement were important for the informal sector. Data on corporate and government sectors are reasonably correct. With the availability of unincorporated enterprises data, the non-agricultural informal sector data on manufacturing, trade, transport and

The new series invalidates completely the general apprehension of near collapse of informal sector post demonetisation, GST rollout and the pandemic

services are available on a regular basis.

Agriculture data, based on crop cutting survey, are reasonably better. It is generally believed that the informal sector, which contributes nearly 40 per cent of GVA, was relatively adversely affected because of structural changes in the economy such as demonetisation and GST and the pandemic, resulting in an overestimation of GDP on the basis of the formal sector data. It is, therefore, important to look at the informal sector’s contribution to macro parameters in view of the latest data sets. The Table summarises key parameters of the informal sector in the old and new series of national accounts.

Three observations can be made from

the Table. First, the informal sector has not witnessed any deterioration relative to other sectors (corporate and government). In fact, the informal sector has grown better than other sectors in gross value added, with growth in 2023-24 and 2024-25 being 12.9 per cent and 9.7 per cent respectively compared to economy wide growth of 10.7 per cent and 9.6 per cent. The share of the informal sector in GVA in new series is higher than in the old series.

Second, capital formation in the informal sector is poor. The investment/GVA ratio of the informal sector has been quite sticky at 33-34 per cent compared to nearly 38 per cent for the non-informal sector. This situation is the same in both the old and new series. Steady lower capital intensity could be a reason. However, the gap is not wide enough to suggest credit distortions or their crowding out.

Third, the share of the informal sector in total savings has declined rather sharply in the new series; an upsurge is seen only in 2022-23. One reason is that the sector is witnessing stress due to reducing profitability.

WHAT THE NEW SERIES REVEALS

The new series invalidates completely the general apprehension of near collapse of informal sector post demonetisation, GST rollout and the pandemic. The informal sector, particularly the non-agriculture segment, has been equally robust, though productivity growth and marketing tie-ups with established players is required.

Secondly, notwithstanding this invalidation, more disclosure is needed about the growth of the informal sector, as what the new series indicates is in contradiction to the growth seen in the quarterly surveys of unincorporated enterprises.

Third, with the investment/GDP ratio nearly stagnating for both the formal and informal sectors, measures for accelerating the ratio beyond their current levels are required. Underutilised capacity may provide some cushion; but with reducing product cycle due to innovation, destruction of excess capacity could occur.

The Union Budget does talk about support to innovation and legacy industries including MSMEs, but it still has not fully assessed the threats.

Gopalan is former Secretary, Economic Affairs, and Singhi is former Senior Economic Adviser, Ministry of Finance. Views expressed are personal

When platform design poses a regulatory risk

Regulators are now taking serious note of manipulative designs in websites and apps intended to shape consumer choice

Shwetasree Majumder

If you have ever rushed to complete an online purchase because a timer warned you “Only 2 minutes left!”, only to see the same timer reset the next day, you have encountered what regulators call a “dark pattern”.

Dark patterns are design tricks built into websites and apps that nudge, or sometimes push, consumers into decisions they may not otherwise make. They include hidden charges that appear only at checkout, pre-ticked subscription boxes, confusing cancellation processes, or messages that create artificial urgency. Individually, these may seem like minor irritants. At scale, regulators believe they distort consumer choice.

Over the past year, India has begun treating these practices not as clever marketing, but as potential violations of consumer law.

A landmark study of 11,000 shopping websites identified 1,818 instances of dark patterns and documented third-party vendors offering such tools at scale.

INDIA'S REGULATORY SHIFT

India's Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, notified by the Central Consumer Protection Authority in 2023 under the Consumer Protection Act, expressly categorise

specific interface designs as unfair trade practices, collapsing the distance between design choice and legal exposure.

The Central Consumer Protection Authority has also issued advisories calling on platforms to conduct internal self-audits and, in some cases, to submit compliance declarations. The regulatory focus seems to be on whether platforms have reviewed their user flows, identified risks, and taken corrective action.

This signals a shift from reactive enforcement to proactive supervision. With 2026 widely expected to see stronger enforcement, businesses have a narrow window to prepare.

What makes dark patterns scrutiny particularly consequential is that it does not sit neatly within consumer law alone. Design choices that limit real choice or hide key information can also raise issues under data protection, advertising and even competition law. Consent obtained through manipulative design may fail the standard of being free and informed under India's data protection framework and misrepresentation can simultaneously raise issues under advertising standards.

At the margins, where platforms exploit behavioural biases at scale, design choices may also attract competition law scrutiny as exploitative conduct, particularly in markets characterised by lock-in and asymmetry



DARK PATTERN. Nudging consumers

of information. The regulatory risk, therefore, is not siloed. A single problematic user journey can trigger parallel exposure across consumer protection, data protection, advertising regulation, and, in time, competition law.

For marketplaces and intermediaries, the challenge is sharper. Many elements of the consumer experience are layered: sellers set prices, logistics partners update delivery timelines, marketing tools generate prompts. The final interface is often the result of multiple systems interacting.

Yet from a regulator's perspective, the origin of a misleading nudge matters less than its effect. If a platform enables a checkout process that obscures costs or makes exit difficult, liability may follow, even if no single team intended to mislead. At digital scale, small design choices can affect millions of users

simultaneously. That amplifies both impact and risk.

Traditionally, compliance in digital businesses centred on terms of service, privacy policies and filings. Dark pattern scrutiny changes that. The focus is shifting to product design itself.

This does not mean lawyers must sit in every design meeting. But it does mean companies need internal mechanisms to review high-risk flows — cancellation processes, default settings, subscription prompts, consent requests — before they go live.

Forward-looking businesses are embedding legal and compliance checks earlier in product development, rather than treating them as post-launch corrections. Where regulators are openly encouraging self-audits, the absence of internal review may itself invite questions.

The scrutiny of dark patterns reflects a broader rethinking of how consumer protection applies in the digital economy.

For India's fast-growing digital platforms, the question is no longer whether interface design will attract regulatory attention. It is whether governance systems are ready for it. In the race to optimise conversion rates, businesses may have to pay equal attention to something less glamorous but far more enduring: trust.

The writer is Managing Partner, Fidus Law Chambers

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Step up vigil

This refers to 'Lessons from Haryana' (March 5). The recent banking scam in handling government accounts exposed the weakness in monitoring and controlling the system of funds transfer. While there are several loopholes on the State government side too, much blame was unfortunately on the bank side. Though RBI said there was no systemic fault, it has to take very serious actions on the bank as well as on the erring officials. The incident also highlights the need for a

thorough screening and background check of persons during the hiring process. Such incidents put the banks in poor light and erode the confidence and trust among the public.

RBI has to make it mandatory to have six eye checks for such transactions involving bulk transfer of funds. It also has to ensure that necessary alert messages reach the concerned depositor or the official account holder on all financial and non-financial activities.

RV Baskaran
Pune

Critical strategy

It is with reference to the news article 'Strategy to secure critical minerals' (March 5). As over 90 per cent of critical minerals like lithium and cobalt are currently imported, India must formulate a new strategy to mitigate these vulnerabilities. Recognising the urgency of securing critical minerals, it can engage with resource-rich nations like Australia and Chile. India has to reassess its minerals security strategy and enhance diplomatic outreach and bolster

domestic capabilities. It must prioritize geological mapping, enable private participation and uphold the environmental safeguards to tap its untapped critical mineral resources and reduce import dependency.

P Victor Selvaraj
Palayamkottai (TN)

Speed caution

This refers to 'Speed is not always a virtue in finance' (March 5). The Deputy Governor's observations make much sense for today's bankers. With 'speed' increasingly becoming the 'taraka mantra' in

banking operations, there is always the risk of some dilution in credit appraisal. Such compromises can quickly impair the quality of the credit portfolio and lead to huge provisions.

While leveraging technology for efficiency and outreach, banks would do well to keep the core principles of corporate governance uppermost in their minds, particularly in their lending practices. In banking, speed should never supersede sound judgement.

R Mohan
Kumbakonam

QUICKLY.

Nexus Select Mall settles REIT violation allegations



New Delhi: Nexus Select Mall Management has settled allegations of flouting REIT norms with SEBI after paying ₹24.37 lakh settlement fee. SEBI said Nexus Select Mall Management remitted the amount to settle the allegations of failing to maintain the required net worth and failing to inform the regulator about the change in the net worth. After receipt of the settlement amount, the adjudication proceedings initiated against the applicant vide a show-cause notice dated June 11, 2025, is disposed of in terms of the Settlement Regulations, the order noted. PTI

Embassy REIT raises ₹1,400 cr via 10-year NCDs

Bengaluru: Embassy Office Parks REIT has raised ₹1,400 crore through its second 10-year Non-Convertible Debenture (NCD) issuance this fiscal. The issuance was priced at a fixed coupon of 7.49 per cent for a 10-year tenor and was fully subscribed by one of India's largest life insurance companies. Amit Shetty, CEO, Embassy REIT, said, "This latest raise is part of our broader capital-raising strategy to extend the average duration of our debt portfolio while market conditions remain favourable. This transaction marks our second 10-year debt issuance within the same financial year, underscoring our consistent ability to access long-term capital at competitive rates." OUR BUREAU

Iran's olive branch rumours spark Sensex surge; index reclaims 80,000

BETTER MOMENTUM. Markets snap a three-session losing streak on the back of improved investor sentiment

Anupama Ghosh Mumbai

Equity benchmarks staged a sharp recovery on Thursday, snapping a three-session losing streak, after rumours surfaced that Iran had conditionally offered to abandon its nuclear programme raised hopes of de-escalation in the ongoing US-Israel-Iran conflict. The BSE Sensex surged 899.71 points to close at 80,015.90, while the Nifty 50 gained 285.40 points to settle at 24,765.90. Earlier in the session, both indices gave up a portion of intra-day gains after an initial surge. The catalyst for the rally was a combination of geopolitical and trade-related developments.

The US announced security and insurance guarantees for commercial shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, including the possibility of military escorts for oil tankers, easing fears of disruption to global energy supplies. Separately, a US Deputy Secretary indicated that India-US bilateral trade deal negotiations are nearing completion. Vinod Nair, Head of Research at Geojit Investments, said: "Investor sentiment improved after comments from the US deputy secretary suggested that an India-US trade deal may be nearing completion... Market momentum strengthened toward the close after reports that Iran



SMART RECOVERY. Earlier, both indices had given up a portion of their intra-day gains after an initial surge

had conditionally offered to abandon its nuclear programme." Broader markets outperformed the frontline indices. The Nifty Midcap 100 and Nifty Smallcap 100 indices gained 1.52 per cent and 1.58 per cent, respectively. On the BSE, 2,749 stocks advanced against 1,515 declines, while

133 remained unchanged. However, 381 stocks hit fresh 52-week lows, against only 66 at 52-week highs, reflecting lingering stress in pockets of the market. BROAD-BASED GAINS Sectorally, the gains were broad-based. The Nifty Metal index advanced 2.29

per cent, Nifty Infra index - 2.21 per cent, Nifty Auto - 1.86 per cent and the India Defence index - 2.5 per cent. The Nifty IT index was the lone sectoral loser, slipping 0.59 per cent. Among individual stocks, Mazagon Dock was a standout gainer, surging around 8 per cent on reports of a potential ₹99,000-crore defence deal. BSE Ltd rose over 4 per cent after receiving SEBI approval to launch index derivatives on two additional indices. Adani Ports and Hindalco Industries were among the top Nifty performers. On the losing side, Tech Mahindra and ICICI Bank were the key laggards, weighed down by profit booking and subdued sectoral sentiment.

Nifty IT slips as Kotak flags GenAI disruption risks

IT's on a slide

	Previous close	Close	% change
Nifty IT	30,305.25	30,126.80	-0.59
Infosys	1,307.40	1,305.30	-0.16
Wipro	195.55	195.80	0.13
TCS	2,587.80	2,575.00	-0.49
HCLTech	1,364.00	1,355.70	-0.61
TechMahindra	1,351.20	1,322.50	-1.38
Mphasis	2,267.20	2,230.90	-1.60
Coforge	1,170.00	1,153.00	-1.45
Persistent Systems	4,709.10	4,636.00	-1.55

Madhu Balaji Bengaluru

Erasing early gains, the Nifty IT index slipped into the red on Thursday, as Kotak analysts flagged rising disruption risks from generative AI for the sector. The Nifty IT index dipped 0.59 per cent to settle at 30,126.80, hitting an intra-day low of 29,823.15 in today's trade after a positive opening at 30,554.85 from the previous close of 30,305.25.

at ₹3,090, Infosys at ₹1,530 and Tech Mahindra at ₹1,615. It assigns a target price of ₹1,425 for HCLTech and ₹190 for Wipro.

AI-LED CONCERNS A recent report by the brokerage highlighted rising risks from generative AI adoption, which it believes could trigger revenue deflation for IT services companies in the coming years. The brokerage now factors in around 3-3.5 per cent revenue deflation for the global IT services industry in FY27-28, higher than its earlier estimate of 2-3 per cent. The increase reflects faster innovation cycles in AI models, growing enterprise adoption and an AI-first approach among developers and technology firms. While generative AI is expected to reshape the industry, Kotak does not believe the shift will eliminate the need for IT services companies. Instead, it expects the sector to remain structurally relevant over the long term, even as the pace of growth moderates and productivity gains reshape revenue models. However, the brokerage warned that evolving AI capabilities and enterprise adoption trends could lead to periodic volatility in IT stocks as investors reassess the sector's long-term growth trajectory.

Sedemac Mechatronics: Wait for the green signal

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan bl. research bureau

Sedemac Mechatronics (SML), a tier-I auto ancillary player, has its IPO open till Friday. The ₹1,087-crore issue is a pure offer-for-sale, driven by investor shareholders (VCs, AIFs, life insurers), while a couple of promoters/promoter-group investors sell only a small part. Promoters and promoter group together hold the power to veto a special resolution before (26.5 per cent) and after the IPO (26.2 per cent).

IPO ANALYSIS.

Unlike typical parts suppliers, SML is primarily a research-driven outfit, originally found in an IIT Bombay lab in 2007. Today, it is run by over 150 professionals from IITs, NITs and BITS. R&D expenses account for 7-10 per cent of revenue and the company holds 12 patents. In FY23-25, SML's revenue and profit rose at CAGRs of 25 per cent and 124 per cent to ₹658 crore and ₹47 crore. In 9MFY26, revenue and profit reached ₹771 crore and ₹71 crore. Operating margin in 9MFY26 is 21 per cent, up from 13 per cent in FY23, driven by higher gross margins and scale. At the upper price band, the issue values SML at 63x 9M FY26 annualised earnings and 126x FY25 net profit. Indian listed peers trade at lower multiples with similar margins but are larger in size (see table). Still, the businesses are not directly comparable: Schaeffler India's key product is bearings, Sona BLW's is transmission gears, while SML focusses on ECUs (electronic control units). Direct competitors to SML include Japan-listed Shindengen Electric, Denso and Mikuni, trading at 9x, 15x and 4x trailing earnings, per Bloomberg. Germany's Bosch, with a wide portfolio, competes with SML in EFI ECUs (electronic fuel injection) and MCUs (motor control units). While the parent is unlisted, Bosch's Indian arm trades at 49x. A JV between India's Varroc Engineering and Italy's Del'Orto JV also rivals SML's EFI ECUs; Varroc (which consolidates the JV) trades at 45x. Given the management's technical depth and the growth record outlined in the prospectus, SML could be well-

How peers stack up

	P/E (x)*	Revenue (₹ cr)	EBITDA margin (%)
Sedemac Mechatronics	63	771	21
Bosch (India)	49	14,469	18
Schaeffler India	56	6,962	20
Sona BLW	51	3,192	27
ZF CV Control Systems	58	2,964	21

Peers are as identified by the RHP. Revenue and EBITDA margins are as of 9M FY26. For Schaeffler, 9 months is from Jan-Sep 2026. *P/E is based on trailing 12 months' earnings. For Sedemac, it is based on 9M FY26 annualised PAT. Source: RHP, Bloomberg

placed as product penetration rises. But the risk factors flagged below suggest the issue is fully priced for now, with most positives already baked in. It also helps to be a bit conservative in today's choppy markets. Investors interested in the company can track execution post-listing and consider entry at more favourable levels.

ABOUT THE COMPANY

Sedemac designs and supplies ECUs to OEMs. An ECU is a semiconductor on a PCB (printed circuit board) that controls a device using software instructions — typically, an engine or motor for SML. The company operates in two verticals: mobility (85 per cent of revenue) and industrial (15 per cent). Exports are negligible in mobility, but form about 60 per cent of industrial revenue, translating to about 9 per cent of total revenue. Under the mobility vertical, SML supplies EFI ECUs, ISG ECUs and ISG+EFI ECUs for ICE two- and three-wheelers. For electric two-wheelers and e-bicycles, it supplies MCUs and rare-earth-free motors. In engines using fuel injection technology (carburettor earlier), an EFI ECU controls the quantity and timing of fuel injected into engine cylinders. EFI became mainstream post the 2020 BS-VI emission norms. ISG stands for integrated starter-generator. It replaces the conventional starter motor-alternator duo with one alternator that can both crank the engine at start and later charge the battery when the engine is running. The ISG ECU enables this. ISG supports silent starts and idle start-stop. Eliminating the starter motor, along with idle start-stop, helps save weight and fuel. Most ISG alternators rely on sensors, which can face reliabil-

ity issues when temperature, dust and oil cause failures. SML was the first in India to design and manufacture SLC (sensorless commutation) based ISG ECUs in 2018 and has a 35 per cent share of the ISG ECU market. An ISG+EFI ECU integrates EFI and ISG functions into one unit, reducing cost for OEMs. In EVs, the MCU regulates the motor based on parameters such as temperature, current and voltage. EV motors typically use permanent magnets made from rare earths elements. To reduce dependence on rare-earth magnets, SML offers ferrite magnet-based motors. Under the industrial vertical, SML supplies GCs (genset controllers) and EFI ECUs. GCs are ECUs used in diesel generators. They detect power failures in real time and automatically start the generator to ensure uninterrupted supply. This business is largely domestic. EFI ECUs here perform the same fuel-control role, but for gas engine-based generators. SML typically exports these EFI ECUs. GROWTH DRIVERS E-two-wheeler penetration in India is about 6 per cent and is estimated to reach 22 per cent by FY30, as per a Crisil Intelligence report cited in the RHP. This can aid SML's EV business (MCUs), which is currently just 2 per cent of the mobility vertical's volume. ISG adoption in domestic two- and three-wheelers was 36 per cent in FY25. Crisil expects this to cross 50 per cent by FY31. Any further adoption by OEMs would provide incremental growth beyond the organic volume expansion among OEMs already using ISG. SML's entry into the commercial vehicles (CVs) space is in early stages. RHP suggests it has received letters of intent from a

IPO rating

Sedemac Mechatronics	
Business	★★★★★
Financials	★★★★★
Management	★★★★★
Valuation	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★
Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest	
Offer period	Mar 4 - 6, 2026
Price band	₹1,287-1,352
Market cap	approx. ₹6,000 cr

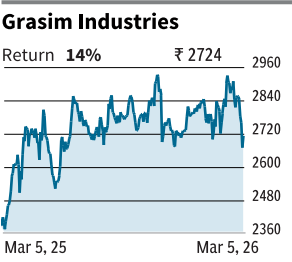
few OEMs for after-treatment control modules (ACMs). ACMs are mandatory for BS-VI vehicles and are used in selective catalytic reduction—the process to curb nitrogen oxide emissions. The firm has also demonstrated MCUs for electric light CVs as a proof-of-concept. RISK FACTORS Customer concentration is high. TVS alone contributes 75 per cent of 9MFY26 revenue, and the top three customers account for 91 per cent. This risk stems from SML's model. Unlike typical suppliers who build to OEM specifications, SML researches and develops solutions to industry challenges, proves them as a proof-of-concept and then pitches them to OEMs. Readers can recall how the company came up with SLC-based ISG ECUs to solve for unreliable ISGs with sensors. OEMs would then reciprocate if they see value in the solution. The ones who adopt early become the 'anchor clients' (like TVS). Wider adoption by other OEMs can take years — keeping concentration elevated. TVS' share has eased to 75 per cent from 80 per cent in FY25, but remains large. The RHP also notes that customers, including TVS, are not contractually bound to minimum purchases or exclusive sourcing — exposing SML to demand swings and price competition. That said, as ECUs are critical to consistent powertrain output, switching costs could deter OEMs from going to another supplier. Finally, the underlying two- and three-wheeler market is cyclical and not structurally high-growth. Crisil estimates industry volumes to grow at a CAGR of 6-8 per cent in FY25-31.

TODAY'S PICK.

Grasim Industries (₹2,724.85): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu bl. research bureau

The stock of Grasim Industries saw a sharp decline in price over the last three weeks. But it has not found support at ₹2,680. Notably, the price action shows that the stock has largely been oscillating within the broad price band of ₹2,680-2,920 since July last year. Therefore, the support at ₹2,680 has been holding well.



Industries now at ₹2,724. Place a stop-loss at ₹2,625. When the price rises to ₹2,800, trail the stop-loss to ₹2,700. On a rally to ₹2,860, tighten the stop-loss to ₹2,800. Exit at ₹2,920.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24832 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24625	24500	25000	25250	Stay out; consider longs only after the breakout of 25000.	

₹878 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
850	835	880	900	The stock is at a resistance; go short with stop-loss at 890.	

₹1,304 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1265	1240	1325	1375	Buy the stock if it breaks out of 1325; stop-loss at 1300.	

₹311 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
308	300	315	318	Initiate short positions at 313; place a stop-loss at 318.	

₹276 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
272	266	281	285	Stock retains bearish bias; sell at 281 with stop-loss at 285.	

₹1,389 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1370	1340	1400	1440	Recovery faces hurdle; buy above 1400 with stop-loss at 1370.	

₹1,171 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1150	1140	1175	1185	Go short if the price rises to 1175; keep stop-loss at 1190.	

₹2,583 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2560	2525	2630	2685	Buy the stock if it breaks out of 2630; stop-loss at 2580.	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Reliance Ind	1389.40	65.77	19.23	8.31
L&T	4038.70	40.22	29.28	4.20
HDFC Bank	877.75	30.54	17.44	11.89
M&M	3348.00	16.39	24.63	2.65
NTPC	378.05	12.74	14.76	1.59
Hindalco	954.95	10.52	13.35	1.22
Adani Ports	1499.30	10.50	27.64	0.98
Bharat Elec	460.00	10.33	56.39	1.46
Bajaj Finance	962.40	10.08	32.68	2.26
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1039.50	9.06	21.38	1.29
Sun Pharma	1784.50	7.90	39.09	1.67
PowerGrid Corp	299.45	7.45	17.94	1.20
Mazda Suzuki	744.00	7.40	30.35	1.68
JSW Steel	1248.10	7.23	39.30	1.04
Coal India	449.40	7.10	9.31	0.90
Tata Steel	200.57	6.96	27.45	1.47
Titan	4275.20	6.41	79.64	1.56
Kotak Bank	407.30	6.37	21.55	2.65
Int'l Grp	4512.80	5.95	54.34	0.90
UltraTech Cement	12288.00	4.71	47.25	1.29
Eicher Motors	7755.00	3.88	39.71	0.96
Bajaj Auto	9804.50	3.70	30.82	0.95
Grasim Ind	2724.10	3.43	19.57	0.92
Reddy's Lab	1313.50	2.98	19.85	0.71
Bajaj Finserv	1911.80	2.82	15.91	0.97
Apollo Hosp	7775.00	2.46	59.92	0.71
Tata Motors PV	355.15	1.81	48.30	0.66
Trent Ltd.	3790.90	1.66	83.19	0.75
Cipla	1326.40	1.63	23.63	0.66
SBI Life	1945.00	1.42	79.51	0.77
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	243.10	1.29	96.24	0.71
Tata Consumer Product	1119.10	1.21	75.26	0.65
Nestle India	1250.90	0.88	73.95	0.79
Adani Enter	2089.20	0.73	17.06	0.48
Max Healthcare	1058.20	0.73	72.53	0.70
Bharti Airtel	1907.00	0.67	29.35	4.71
Asian Paints	2287.80	0.26	56.12	0.92
Wipro	195.68	0.08	15.39	0.49
HDFC Life	684.30	-0.07	77.98	0.65
ONGC	276.35	-0.51	7.73	0.95
Eternal Ltd.	240.14	-0.93	100.22	1.53
ITC	311.50	-0.95	18.85	2.66
Hind Unilever	2255.00	-1.23	52.69	1.77
Infosys	1305.80	-1.23	18.91	4.05
Axis Bank	1349.10	-1.37	15.96	3.42
TCS	2578.80	-2.02	19.45	2.33
HCL Tech	1354.10	-2.29	22.31	1.27
Tech Mahindra	1333.30	-2.49	28.45	0.75
State Bank	1169.50	-4.55	12.47	4.30
ICICI Bank	1357.60	-12.22	17.15	8.59

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Power Finance	413.65	74.70	4.09	2.67
Varun Beverages	445.75	65.69	49.23	2.70
Tata Power	376.85	55.42	24.04	2.80
Vedanta	711.25	52.17	16.79	5.35
Tvs Motor Cmp.	3818.40	50.51	59.41	3.97
Rural Elec	341.85	49.09	5.22	1.89
Sarmadarmothersoninternatl	126.34	46.11	36.64	2.49
Mazagon Dock	235.50	42.65	39.43	0.79
Cg Power & Ind Sol	701.10	33.37	99.52	2.10
Ayresunepower	3835.14	32.91	67.14	2.53
Oil	585.15	30.99	32.71	1.66
Adani Energy Solutions	987.90	28.52	49.78	1.52
Adani Power	140.11	27.10	23.91	2.45
Britannia Ind	5963.00	26.01	59.44	3.12
Havells	1352.50	25.58	57.21	1.51
Hyundai Motor India	2134.40	23.96	29.95	1.35
Rpci	1460.35	22.97	6.35	3.09
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1669.00	19.54	29.06	3.13
Divis Lab	636.50	18.49	68.16	3.58
Jsw Energy	479.50	18.43	32.19	1.14
Info Edge I	1015.30	18.18	39.07	1.75
Jindal Steel	1184.00	17.49	59.91	1.96
Gail (India)	156.73	17.16	11.97	1.87
Canara Bank	148.51	15.98	7.32	2.22
Abb India	5929.00	15.50	74.50	1.38
Siemens	3215.70	14.50	72.23	1.26
Icici Lombard Gic	1875.20	14.31	33.35	2.01
Bank Of Baroda	301.85	14.19	7.95	2.48
ZydusIntelligence	314.65	13.33	18.31	1.01
Indian Oilcorp	121.54	12.33	6.57	2.84
Adanigreenenergy	884.55	11.59	78.50	1.20
Solar Industries	14671.00	10.82	86.96	1.58
Punjab Natl Bank	122.20	8.59	7.86	1.87
Hindustanaeronautics	3891.80	8.54	29.26	3.27
United Spirits	1325.80	7.98	56.07	1.73
Ambuja Cements	480.00	7.04	24.11	1.30
Pillidindi	1445.90	6.34	63.59	1.99
Indian Railway Finance Corp.	98.85	5.95	18.44	0.78
Hindus Zinc	595.65	5.72	21.33	1.14
Torrent Pharma	4353.40	3.89	64.85	2.02
Lic	832.95	3.26	10.31	8.62
Macrotech Developers	916.25	2.87	27.35	1.14
Bajaj Holdings	10663.00	1.56	13.24	2.05
Bajaj Housing Finance	84.63	1.38	28.46	0.35
Bosch	33230.00	-4.16	35.55	1.28
Godrej Consumer	1132.40	-6.16	63.61	0.72
Shree Cement	25200.00	-6.22	50.62	1.49
Indian Hotels Co.	6239.00	-10.67	41.41	2.45
Limtindree	4306.00	-11.94	27.03	1.77
Siemens Energy India	2863.90	-20.72	86.34	1.12

FMCG growth moderated to 7.8% in Dec quarter on GST transition: NielsenIQ

BIG CHURN. Nearly 60% of the FMCG portfolio underwent rate revisions, requiring pricing adjustments

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

India’s FMCG industry re-recorded muted value growth of 7.8 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) in the October-December period on the back of volume growth of 2.6 per cent and price growth of 5.1 per cent as per the latest data released by NielsenIQ. This was sequentially lower than the value growth of 13 per cent y-o-y recorded in the September quarter.

The moderation in growth was attributed to higher festive base and transitional adjustments linked to GST rate revisions. At the same time, the e-commerce channel’s share reached 6 per cent of urban FMCG sales with quick-commerce accounting for three-fourth of e-commerce FMCG sales in the December quarter.

GST TRANSITION

Nearly 60 per cent of the FMCG portfolio underwent GST rate revisions, requiring coordinated pricing adjustments across manufacturers, distributors, and retailers.

“Both price and volume growth softened sequentially, particularly within traditional trade, which experienced temporary supply and pricing recalibration during the initial phase of implementation,” NIQ stated in



HIGHER CONSUMPTION. Rural regions continued to outpace urban regions for the eighth consecutive quarter but the gap narrowed in the December quarter

its quarterly snapshot report. However, it noted that there had been stabilisation in the GST transition with improved availability of GST-related launches and pricing alignment across the retail network.

“The FMCG industry witnessed heightened activity following GST 2.0 implementation, with expectations of demand stimulus across categories. While initial supply and pricing adjustments led to moderated consumption in the October-December quarter, organised channels responded faster to structural changes. We expect the positive impact of GST 2.0 on consumption to become more visible from the January-February-March (JFM 2026) quarter onwards,” said Sharang Pant,

Head of Customer Success-FMCG and Tech & Durables, NielsenIQ India.

RURAL SHOW

Rural regions continued to outpace urban regions for the eighth consecutive quarter but the gap narrowed in the December quarter. Rural regions recorded 2.9 per cent volume growth in Q4 CY 2025, moderating against a higher base.

Urban markets grew 2.3 per cent, supported by a recovery in metro consumption and normalisation in e-commerce demand.

E-COMMERCE

E-commerce continued its upward trajectory and accounted for nearly 6 per cent of urban India’s FMCG sales in the December quarter. It

now contributes nearly 18 per cent to FMCG sales in the top 18 metros and 14 per cent across all metros. “Quick commerce, contributing over three-fourths of e-commerce FMCG sales, remains the key growth engine,” NIQ added.

Regionally, southern metros have surpassed 21 per cent e-commerce share of FMCG sales, while northern and eastern metros are narrowing the gap with modern trade. Western markets continue to see modern trade leadership, though e-commerce is steadily gaining share from traditional trade.

Meanwhile, the kirana channel grew merely 1.1 per cent in volume y-o-y in December quarter. Modern trade grew 15.5 per cent y-o-y, recording a three-fold

acceleration in OND 2025 compared to the September quarter, on faster pricing execution and stronger operational systems.

CATEGORY WISE

In terms of categories, both food and home & personal care (HPC) saw moderation in volume growth during the December quarter. Food segment volume grew 2.8 per cent and value grew 8.8 per cent. Food consumption benefited from GST-led price reduction and stabilisation in edible oil prices.

HPC recorded a volume growth of 1.3 per cent reflecting sharper moderation due to higher exposure to the GST revisions.

SMALL PLAYERS

Small manufacturers sustained growth momentum (7.1 per cent volume growth) in the December quarter, continuing to outpace the broader FMCG market in volume growth.

“While overall volumes moderated across segments, large FMCG players implemented comparatively steeper price reductions to align with GST adjustments and competitive pressures. Smaller manufacturers demonstrated greater agility in pricing and portfolio adaptation, reinforcing their competitive positioning,” NIQ added.

Commercial vehicle sales rise to 29% in February, Tata Motors retains lead

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Commercial vehicle (CV) retail sales in India rose 29 per cent year-on-year in February 2026 to 1,00,820 units compared with 78,219 units in the same month last year, reflecting steady freight activity and improved fleet utilisation, according to Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) data. All major original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) reported more than 20 per cent growth during the month while their market shares remained largely unchanged.

Tata Motors Ltd continued to dominate the segment with a 35.61 per cent market share in February 2026. It was followed by Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd with 26.79 per cent and Ashok Leyland Ltd with 18.47 per cent, FADA data showed.

Among manufacturers, Daimler India Commercial Vehicles recorded the highest growth at 39.46 per cent, with sales rising to 2,389 units from 1,713 units a year ago. Force Motors Ltd posted the lowest growth at 4.75 per cent, with sales increasing to 2,097 units from 2,002 units.

DEALER FEEDBACK

FADA stated dealer feedback pointed to improved freight availability, steady e-commerce activity and infrastructure-linked demand, supporting fleet additions across regions. The positive



Commercial vehicle OEMs

	Feb 2025	Market share (%) Feb 2025	Feb 2026	Market share (%) Feb 2026
Tata Motors	27,184	34.75	35,900	35.61
Mahindra & Mahindra	21,168	27.06	27,014	26.79
Ashok Leyland	14,606	18.67	18,619	18.47
VE Commercial Vehicles	6,356	8.13	8,263	8.20
Maruti Suzuki India	3,679	4.70	4,489	4.45

Source: FADA

sentiment following the rollout of GST 2.0 also helped boost secondary demand and bulk purchases. However, some regions reported supply constraints for certain models even as the overall booking pipeline remained healthy.

According to Poonam Upadhyay, Director, Crisil Ratings, commercial vehicle volumes remain on a healthy trajectory with demand for medium and heavy commercial vehicles (M&HCVs) leading the growth, supported by strong construction activity, higher mining output and increased goods movement. Growth in light commercial vehicles (LCVs) is being driven by the expansion of e-commerce and last-mile logistics, she said.

Fleet replacement demand is gaining momentum

after being deferred during FY20-FY22 amid the pandemic and the transition to BS-VI emission norms, which increased vehicle costs. The reduction in GST on commercial vehicles to 18 per cent in September 2025 from 28 per cent earlier improved purchase economics and unlocked postponed buying decisions.

Looking ahead, replacement demand and infrastructure-led freight activity are expected to sustain volumes, though growth could moderate to mid-single digits on a higher base, Upadhyay noted.

The 6 per cent month-on-month decline in February sales was largely seasonal, reflecting dispatch timing and purchase bunching rather than any slowdown in demand, she added.

‘Auto component industry to grow 8-10% in FY27’

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Domestic vehicle demand is projected to grow 5-8 per cent in FY27, moderating from the estimated 7-10 per cent growth in FY26, as the industry moves beyond the post-pandemic recovery phase and faces a higher base effect.

India’s auto component sector is entering a phase of structural transformation rather than cyclical expansion. Despite moderating vehicle sales growth, rising technology content, export opportunities and localisation trends are expected to support a stronger growth trajectory for component manufacturers compared with the broader auto industry.

Shruti Saboo, Director, India Ratings & Research, said auto ancillaries are likely to benefit from persistent domestic market demand and continued formalisation of the supply chain following GST revision. She added that export market sentiment is also expected to improve amid favourable trade agreements, which could support investments and research and development in advanced technology compon-

ents and the electric vehicle ecosystem.

The ratings agency said profitability for component manufacturers is expected to improve gradually as input costs stabilise. Prices of key raw materials, such as steel, aluminium and other metals, have eased from earlier peaks, supporting EBITDA margins across the sector and improving free cash flows in FY27. Capital expenditure is also becoming more modular, while net leverage levels are expected to remain broadly stable.

CONTENT PER VEHICLE

One of the most significant advantages for component manufacturers is the rising value of parts per vehicle, as automakers incorporate more electronics, safety systems and advanced materials to meet regulatory and consumer expectations.

India Ratings identified premiumisation as a key demand driver, particularly in passenger vehicles where sport utility vehicles (SUVs) and higher-end models dominate sales. This shift means each vehicle sold carries higher-value components, enabling suppliers to grow revenues even when overall vehicle volumes expand at a slower pace.

IBM launches innovation centre

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

IBM has launched its first infrastructure innovation centre, the Sangam Infrastructure Innovation Center, at its new India Systems Development Lab (ISDL) campus.

It will bring together IBM’s systems architects and infrastructure specialists from ISDL to co-create AI solutions with clients.

the hindu businessline.

Classifieds

TENDERS

HOMCK KERALA

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NASHIK MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, NASHIK
E-Tender Cell Department
Notice No. 67 (Year 2025-26)

E-Tender Notice Regarding the **PWD Department 1** work of Nashik Municipal Corporation Nashik. vide E-Tender Notice No.67 (Year 2025-26) invites bids for which will be displayed on the website www.mahatenders.gov.in from Dt.04/03/2026 to Dt.02/04/2026 up to 17.30 pm Last date for acceptance of tender will be Dt.02/04/2026.

Note - All further necessary notices/clarifications will be published on the online website.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
E-Tender Cell
Nashik Municipal Corporation

जनसंपर्क : जा.क्र./४७८/२०२६
दि.४/३/२०२६
गोदा प्रदुषण टाका, भविष्य संभाका

PITTI PITTI ENGINEERING LIMITED
CIN: L29253TG1983PLC004141
Regd. Office: 6-3-648/401, IV Floor, Padmaja Landmark, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082, Website: www.pitti.in, Ph: 040-23312774, Email : shares@pitti.in.

POSTAL BALLOT NOTICE

Members of the Company are hereby informed that a Postal Ballot Notice seeking their consent on the ordinary resolution set out therein has been sent electronically to all Members whose email IDs are registered with the Company / MUFG Intime India Private Limited, the Company’s Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, or with their respective Depository Participant(s), as on the cut off date, Friday, 27th February 2026. The Company completed the electronic dispatch of the Postal Ballot Notice on Thursday, 5th March 2026.

The Postal Ballot Notice is available on the website of the Company (www.pitti.in), and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges where the Company’s equity shares are listed: BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (www.nseindia.com). It is also available on the MUFG e voting portal at <https://instavote.linkintime.co.in/>. Members who do not receive the Postal Ballot Notice may download it from these websites.

Instructions for e voting
In accordance with applicable Ministry of Corporate Affairs circulars, the Company is providing Members the facility to vote on the resolution(s) proposed in the Postal Ballot Notice only through electronic voting (remote e voting). Members may convey their assent or dissent exclusively through this mode.

E voting Details:

a) Cut-off date	Friday, 27th February 2026
b) Commencement of remote e-voting	Friday, 6th March 2026 (9:00 A.M IST)
c) End of remote e-voting	Saturday, 4th April 2026 (5:00 P.M IST)
d) For e-voting queries contact	evoting@nsdl.co.in helpline: evoting@cisindia.com 022-48867000 1800 22 55 33

Members may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and the InstaVote e Voting manual available under the “Help” section at <https://instavote.linkintime.co.in> or contact MUFG at enotices@in.mpmf.com or by calling 022-49186000. E-voting will not be permitted beyond the specified period. The e voting module shall be disabled automatically upon expiry of the above timeline.

Details regarding the manner of e voting for Members holding shares in dematerialized or physical form, and for Members who have not registered their email addresses, are provided in the Postal Ballot Notice. The procedure for retrieving forgotten User IDs or Passwords is also included in the Notice.

Only persons whose names appear in the Register of Members / List of Beneficial Owners as on the cut off date shall be eligible to vote. Voting rights shall be in proportion to the shareholding in the paid up equity share capital as on the cut off date. Persons who become Members after the cut off date may treat the notice for information purposes only.

The resolution(s) proposed in the Postal Ballot Notice, if approved, shall be deemed passed on the last date of e voting, i.e., Saturday, 4th April 2026. The results of the e voting will be announced within two working days, i.e., on or before Tuesday, 7th April 2026, and will be displayed on the Company’s website (www.pitti.in), communicated to the Stock Exchanges, and shared with MUFG. The results will also be displayed at the Company’s Registered Office.

By Order of the Board
For Pitti Engineering Limited
Sd/-
Mary Monica Braganza
Company Secretary & Chief Compliance Officer
Place: Hyderabad Date : 5th March 2026 FCS: 5532

CIAL COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED

CIAL/COMM/SNW/62 TENDER NOTICE 06/03/2026
(E-Tender No: 2026_CIAL_841244)

Item rate E-tenders are invited from reputed contractors for SITC of Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Solution at Cochin International Airport.

Name of Work	Estimate Amount	EMD	Completion Period
SITC of Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Solution	Rs. 15.26 Lakhs + GST	Rs. 50,000/-	3 Months

Interested firms may register themselves on the online E-Tendering portal <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in>. Tender document will be available for download from 13/03/2026. For further details, visit <https://www.cial.aero>

Sd/-
MANAGING DIRECTOR

Malabar Regional Co-operative Milk Producers’ Union Ltd.
Head Office, Peringulam, Kunnamangalam, Kozhikode-673 571, Kerala
Website: www.malabarmla.com, Email: mrcmpu@malabarmla.coop
Phone: 0495-260507, 420, Mobile No: 9188180396

No. MRU/ ENGG/Tender Adv/2025-26/ 05.03.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Tenders are invited from eligible bidders through e-procurement window of Government of Kerala (www.etenders.kerala.gov.in) for the following works.

Item	Closing date
SITC of 10 KLPH Milk Pasteurization Module at Malappuram Dairy. E-tender Id: 2026_KCMMF_844110_1	23.03.2026
Supply of Deep Freezers and Visi Coolers for Various Dairies E-tender Id: 2026_KCMMF_843687_1	26.03.2026
Supply of Milk testing equipments for MRCMPU Ltd E-Tender Id: 2026_KCMMF_843966_1	23.03.2026
Supply of SS items for Milk testing and collection E Tender Id: 2026_KCMMF_829840_2	16.03.2026
SITC incl. maintenance of computer hardware, software and storage devices at various dairies E-tender Id: 2026_KCMMF_843044_1	26.03.2026

For further enquiries, visit our website or contact Head Office, MRCMPU Ltd. Managing Director

Invesco Mutual Fund

Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd.
(CIN: U67190MH2005PTC153471), 2101-A, 21st Floor, A Wing, Marathon Futurex, N. M. Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai - 400 013

Telephone: +91 22 6731 0000, Email: mfservices@invescoindia.com; www.invescomutualfund.com

NOTICE CUM ADDENDUM

ADDENDUM TO THE STATEMENT OF ADDITIONAL INFORMATION OF INVESCO MUTUAL FUND

Notice is hereby given to all the investors / unit holders that it has been decided to carry out following change to Statement of Additional Information (‘SAI’) of the Invesco Mutual Fund (‘the Fund’):

Transfer of Key Personnel from PMS Division to MF Division

Pursuant to joining of Mr. Siddharth Bothra as Principal Officer & Portfolio Manager - Portfolio Management Services (PMS) of Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd. (‘IAMI’), Mr. Punit Pujara ceased to be Principal Officer & Portfolio Manager of PMS of IAMI with effect from close of business hours of **March 5, 2026** and is transferred back from PMS Division of IAMI to Mutual Fund Division of IAMI as Research Analyst - Equity with effect from **March 6, 2026**.

Accordingly, the following details of Mr. Punit Pujara stand inserted in the Statement of Additional Information (‘SAI’) of Invesco Mutual Fund (‘Fund’):

Name	Age (Yrs.)	Designation	Educational Qualification	Total No. of Years of Experience / Type & Nature of Experience	Brief Experience
Mr. Punit Pujara	28	Research Analyst - Equity	B.Com., M.Com., C.A. and C.F.A. Charterholder (CFA Institute)	More than 5 years of experience in research and analysis of companies	March 6, 2026 onwards Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd. February 10, 2026 - March 5, 2026 - Principal Officer & Portfolio Manager - PMS - Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd. September 01, 2025 - February 9, 2026 - Research Analyst - Equity - Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd. March 06, 2023 - July 31, 2025 - Research Analyst - Equity - Helios Capital Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd. September 6, 2021 - March 03, 2023 - Research Associate - IIFL Securities Ltd. September 17, 2020 - August 31, 2021 - Research Associate - Equirus Securities Pvt. Ltd. October 10, 2019 - September 11, 2020 - Credit Analyst - Axis Bank Ltd.

Pursuant to above changes, necessary changes will be carried out at relevant places in SAI of the Fund.

All other terms & conditions of the SAI of the Fund will remain unchanged.

This addendum forms an integral part of the SAI of the Fund, as amended from time to time.

For Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd.
(Investment Manager for Invesco Mutual Fund)

Sd/-

Saurabh Nanavati

Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

Date: March 5, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

A close-up photograph showing a person's hand holding a single gold bar. The bar is rectangular and has some markings on it. Below the hand, there is a tray filled with many more gold bars, stacked in rows. The lighting is warm, highlighting the metallic sheen of the gold.



A person wearing a red hat and a plaid shirt stands in a river, looking towards a large concrete structure. The water is turbulent and white with foam. A small white bird is visible in the upper right corner of the image.

Demand-supply balance

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026f
Mining supply	5.57	5.61	5.78	5.55	5.55
Recycling	1.81	1.51	1.52	1.66	1.83
Total supply	7.38	7.13	7.30	7.21	7.38
Automotive demand	2.76	3.21	3.10	3.03	2.94
Jewellery demand	1.88	1.85	2.00	2.19	1.92
Industrial demand	2.15	2.37	2.40	1.91	2.12
Investment demand	-0.51	0.38	0.70	1.15	0.62
Total demand	6.28	7.82	8.22	8.29	7.61
Balance	1.09	-0.68	-0.92	-1.08	-0.24
Above-ground stocks	5.54	4.85	3.93	2.85	2.61

SOLITAIRE PRICE INDEX

6th March, 2026

4,376*

0.85% ↓ Over last Month	4.14% ↓ Over last Year
--------------------------------------	-------------------------------------

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Released on the 1st of every month.
* This is an average of Divine Solitaires Price List

DIVINE
SOLITAIRE

Return -29.6% per mmBtu

500
425
350
275
200

Mar 05, 25 Mar 03, 26



Dr. Ravi K. Sankar is a senior research advisor at the Center for Communications Programs, University of Illinois at Chicago. He is also a senior research advisor at the Center for Communications Programs, University of Illinois at Chicago. He is also a senior research advisor at the Center for Communications Programs, University of Illinois at Chicago.

CM
Y
K



New Delhi: Online travel company MakeMyTrip has acquired regional tour operator Flamingo Transworld to strengthen its holiday packages business. "Flamingo aligns closely with the growth strategy of our Holiday Packages business. It is a strong, growing business that has developed a unique moat in the group travel domain," said Rajesh Magow, Co-Founder and Group CEO, MakeMyTrip. OUR BUREAU

Chennai: The ePlane Company, an electric vertical takeoff and landing (eVTOL) aircraft, has announced a partnership with Germany-based HENSOLDT Avionics to use the latter's sensor solutions and mission management electronics for its eVTOL aircraft. Through this, the firm will integrate HENSOLDT's advanced avionics suite, into its e200x series of aircraft improving its safety, situational awareness, and operational efficiency in dense urban environments. HENSOLDT's suite of avionics will serve as the 'eyes and ears of the e200x' ensuring safety.

OUR BUREAU

Do you feel the Indian economy is strong enough to deal with the implications of a prolonged war in West Asia?

Well, the real question is, how prolonged and how severe will it be. A lot of oil for India and also for countries like Korea, Japan and China, comes from the Strait of Hormuz. We will all be competing for the same oil.

AI is the buzz now and there are several views on it. What is your view:



RAGHURAM RAJAN
former RBI Governor

will it create more jobs or take them away?
I think all technologies do both. They displace people and they also create jobs. I think, almost surely, AI will probably displace a fair amount of jobs.

The belief is, it will create fewer jobs than it displaces, which is why all this worry about mass unemployment. I think part of that, not entirely, is, we are able to see the jobs that are lost, but we are typically not able to see the jobs

You have stressed on

munication apps, the DoT is being slightly lenient but there's no consensus yet,"

largely focused on consumer AI applications, the true frontier is the biological sector, which is poised for unprecedented disruption, he said.

AI'S CAPABILITIES

He said that AI's predictive capabilities were already outperforming physical chemistry.

Because of these rapid advancements in structural prediction, he felt that "the biosimilars which are there in the world today all be wiped out in the next five

years". He suspects artificial intelligence is already driving massive commercial shifts, pointing out that China licensed \$37 billion worth of monoclonal antibodies in a single year. "They must have used AI to come up with new molecules," he said.

SOFTWARE SECTOR

He appealed to the software industry to reorient toward health, biology, and translational fields, noting that this was where the major future impact lies.

Google may have ended its five-year anti-trust battle with Epic Games on Wednesday but Indian entrepreneurs who took the tech giant to court in India say its policies are still “rent-seeking”, and the overhaul does not change it.

Google announced major concessions to its Play Store policies on March 4, and this includes allowing alternative payment systems inside apps, making third-party app stores easier to install on Android, letting developers direct users to external payment sites, and lowering app store commissions for developers among others. The reforms apply globally in platform policy in phases with a 2027 rollout for mar-

kets like India. However, Indian entrepreneurs who led the antitrust fight with the tech giant in India, are not impressed and see it as a *status quo* in terms of their case against Google.

DOWNLOAD VOLUME
“The fundamental question remains — what services are we actually paying for? For any significant download volume, we are already forced to spend massive amounts on advertising within their own platform. To then demand an additional transaction fee for a customer we acquired and a payment they didn’t process is rent-seeking at its worst,” Shaadi.com Founder Anupam Mittal told *businessline*.

When asked if Google’s recent changes address India’s concerns, he said that

Google is "attempting to bypass the spirit of the CCF's previous orders" by rebranding their fees. "Earlier, when the law turned against Google Play Billing, they introduced 'User Choice Billing' (UCB). Now, they have unbranded the commission into a 'Service Fee' and a 'Payment Fee'. By allowing third party billing but still demanding a heavy 'Service Fee', the total cost to the developer remains virtually un-

changed,” he said.

Murugavel Janakiraman, Founder, Matrimony.com, another vocal critic and part of the complainants, said that despite the changes, developers will still have to pay a fee to Google to host their apps, which is akin to a cut on revenue.

Shaadi.com and Matrimony.com, along with other Indian start-ups and industry bodies like Alliance of Digital India Foundation (ADIF), moved the Competition Commission of India (CCI) back in 2020 alleging anti-competitive practices by Google, which had then made the use of Google Play billing mandatory.

Google then subsequently introduced User Choice Billing to comply with the CCI order. User Choice Billing allows developers to show users an alternative

billing system alongside Google Play Billing. However, the tech entrepreneurs maintained that Google's service fee levy was unfair and it was abusing its monopoly power over the Android app marketplace. Google, in its blog, explained service fee as being based on a percentage of the purchase price of digital purchases on the app and in return for the "significant value" developers receive from Android and Google Play.

SERVICE FEE

"The service fee is also how we earn money and support our investment in Android and Google Play, including enabling us to distribute Android for free, among other things," it noted.

Google did not respond to *businessline's* queries.

Dr. Ravi K. Sankaran

AI INFRASTRUCTURE

He noted that an expected \$55 trillion investment in AI infrastructure by 2030 will inevitably trickle down to businesses, making adoption a pure competitive imperative.

Varrier also highlighted the phenomenal opportunity for India's global capability centres (GCCs). Stating that the country is home to over six million tech employees, he said it is well-positioned to become the 'AI office of the world'.

GCCs, he observed, are no longer coming to India merely for back-office operations, but to build the next generation of AI-powered business capabilities.

To sustain this momentum, Varrier warned of the widening gap between current academic education and industry requirements. He noted that Cognizant is currently working with 20 to 25 colleges to reconfigure syllabi to make them more current.

Varrier concluded by advising the workforce to commit to continuous adaptation. “We have to be absolutely prepared to be lifelong learners,” he said, emphasising that no single skill will sustain a professional for life as every sector faces ongoing technological disruption.

A close-up photograph of a young man with short, dark, wavy hair and a light beard. He is smiling broadly, showing his teeth. He is using his index fingers to apply a white cream or lotion to his cheeks. He is wearing a white t-shirt. The background is a plain, light gray.

searched terms in the category on Flipkart, reflecting a shift from basic grooming to targeted skincare solutions.

The change is also visible in purchasing behaviour. Earlier, men largely bought face washes or shaving products, but demand is now expanding to sunscreens, moisturisers, body lotions and serums.

Haircare products addressing concerns such as hair fall, dandruff and hair growth are also seeing rising traction among male consumers.

SKINCARE ROUTINES

Executives said the rising engagement from men is partly being driven by younger consumers who are discovering skincare through social media and influencer-led content.

On Myntira, men already account for a significant share of beauty purchases.

“One in three beauty shoppers on Myntira is male and they have been driving consistent demand for the category over the past two

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI
20 Microns [5]	166.88	167.43	169.88	171.69	165.33	64.77	2874.80	160.05	10	166.50
360 One WAM [3]	100.84	108.10	108.10	108.10	106.53	31.55	1784.10	790.50	-	100.50
3i Infotech [2]	51.36	51.36	51.36	51.36	51.36	1.33	29.10	31.20	1.33	51.36
3M India [2]	34280.00	34030.00	34690.00	34810.00	33800.00	454	38300.00	25777.00	19	34255.15
SPAISA [2]	30.83	30.95	30.80	31.17	30.55	23.91	43.80	287.95	22	30.985
63 Moonrkt [2]	564.50	588.65	574.70	596.20	560.70	153.53	1130.00	541.50	64	587.85

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	
Aadhar Hes [5]	453.10	453.10	458.00	445.13	387.29	547.80	367.10	-	-	453.10	
Aadhar Exp [5]	68.76	72.74	69.89	73.89	69.00	125.04	100.00	31.35	-	68.76	
Aadru Drugs [5]	140.90	148.14	147.04	164.96	145.82	40.84	47.48	135.01	-	140.90	
Aarti Prgs [5]	360.45	360.80	360.45	364.00	358.80	89.17	574.95	312.50	18	360.50	
Aarti Prgs [5]	127.90	127.90	127.90	127.90	127.90	127.90	127.90	127.90	-	127.90	
Aarti Pharm [5]	67.75	69.85	68.14	70.20	67.10	183.73	97.10	574.45	-	67.75	
Aarti Encon [5]	116.27	130.19	118.06	134.00	118.06	80.62	152.00	88.00	-	116.27	
Aarti Encon [5]	125.20	125.20	125.20	125.20	125.20	125.20	125.20	125.20	-	125.20	
AB Capital [5]	321.55	327.60	325.00	328.75	320.20	369.812	36.25	150.90	29	327.75	
AB Coptsin [5]	38.85	40.25	40.45	41.55	39.65	35.26	50.04	37.10	-	38.85	
AB Infabul [5]	17.34	17.17	17.40	19.50	17.40	1320.19	224.98	17.09	-	17.34	
AB Real Est [5]	126.90	123.40	126.90	123.20	120.50	148.57	758.90	118.00	-	126.90	
AB Sun Life [5]	86.75	89.25	86.75	90.10	86.75	67.93	93.64	556.45	-	86.75	
ABB [2]	578.50	592.50	584.00	600.00	573.50	268.40	490.00	459.00	75	578.50	
ABB Energy [5]	2350.00	2350.00	2350.00	2350.00	2350.00	2350.00	2350.00	2350.00	-	2350.00	
Abbott [1]	2820.00	2761.00	2790.00	2840.00	2782.00	18.83	3921.55	2600.00	33	2792.20	
ABFRL [5]	64.09	64.28	64.09	64.92	63.21	4821.20	107.71	59.82	-	64.09	
ABFL [5]	128.51	127.17	132.65	144.00	125.27	80.11	207.35	114.05	14	127.40	
ABFL [5]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
ACCLEVA [5]	117.79	119.55	118.90	120.99	117.10	12.60	1524.55	1135.05	-	117.79	
ACME Solar [5]	224.57	231.22	224.00	237.20	224.00	40.84	32.04	172.63	-	224.57	
ACME Solar [5]	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	-	98.87	
Acetate Chem [5]	187.60	187.60	187.60	187.60	187.60	187.60	187.60	187.60	-	187.60	
Acutea Chem [5]	201.50	223.90	213.00	224.90	213.00	59.31	2553.65	104.50	-	201.50	
Adant Ent [1]	2074.00	2092.00	2094.00	2100.00	2040.00	1231.52	167.75	185.00	103	2088.45	
Adani [5]	98.67	98.67	98.67	98.67	98.67	98.67	98.67	98.67	-	98.67	
Adani Ports [2]	1454.40	1499.30	1490.20	1505.55	1447.20	3236.48	1584.00	1041.05	174	1499.00	
Adani Pwr [2]	137.82	140.11	139.00	140.85	138.11	827.44	12.75	94.41	26	140.05	
Adani T Gas [5]	480.80	483.45	481.00	486.50	478.48	459.71	798.00	477.00	-	480.80	
Adani T Gas [5]	178.84	178.84	178.84	178.84	178.84	178.84	178.84	178.84	-	178.84	
Adani E.Sol [5]	96.00	96.70	95.10	99.40	96.40	100.66	103.70	639.45	-	96.00	
Adi Foods [2]	130.39	138.91	139.98	145.00	137.19	75.43	30.10	168.80	-	130.39	
Adi Foods [2]	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	98.87	-	98.87	
Aditya Birla [5]	168.50	170.70	168.80	174.30	168.80	31.66	175.00	101.00	-	168.50	
Aditya Birla [5]	40.32	46.85	42.10	48.25	40.25	32.05	58.00	37.60	-	40.32	
AdorWelding [5]	102.10	103.20	103.20	104.50	103.20	42.49	126.00	72.80	-	102.10	
AdorWelding [5]	152.20	152.20	152.20	152.20	152.20	152.20	152.20	152.20	-	152.20	
Advance Agro [5]	109.55	109.25	111.00	112.84	108.06	52.44	15.00	102.00	-	109.55	
Advent Hotel [5]	184.18	191.20	186.66	195.00	179.00	96.08	34.05	105.00	-	184.18	
Advent Hotel [5]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
AEGIS [5]	64.35	66.65	66.00	67.60	64.90	34.22	94.50	63.90	56	66.25	
Aegis Vopak [5]	199.60	188.80	199.00	203.99	184.20	34.96	32.00	184.20	-	199.60	
AEGIS [5]	136.50	136.08	137.00	138.50	134.47	453.20	16.05	131.14	-	136.50	
AEGIS [5]	223.72	223.72	223.72	223.72	223.72	223.72	223.72	223.72	-	223.72	
Aether Ind [5]	91.67	96.70	91.50	97.00	91.75	189.51	1083.60	72.50	-	91.67	
Afcons Infra [5]	279.30	284.75	279.00	287.00	276.25	311.73	47.98	273.10	-	279.30	
Afcons Infra [5]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
Agarwal Ind [5]	50.85	48.20	50.05	51.30	48.20	100.17	109.95	71.90	18	47.95	
Agri Greenpac [5]	520.80	510.20	526.50	536.50	505.00	257.64	100.00	500.05	-	520.80	
Agri Greenpac [5]	30.85	31.35	30.55	31.35	30.05	31.35	31.35	31.35	-	30.85	
AHLUWALIA [5]	71.50	72.50	71.50	72.50	71.50	72.50	72.50	72.50	-	71.50	
AHLUWALIA [5]	362.30	361.75	362.00	368.50	359.00	26.80	420.00	360.00	26	362.30	
Ajanta Pha [2]	291.30	294.70	292.00	298.00	290.00	11.45	305.20	202.00	39	294.70	
Ajanta Pha [2]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
Ajmera [2]	125.92	123.78	124.96	129.69	122.35	30.51	22.13	122.90	-	125.92	
Akme Fin [5]	7.13	7.23	7.25	7.29	6.95	29.17	6.10	7.00	3.92	-	7.13
Akme Fin [5]	46.00	46.00	46.00	46.00	46.00	46.00	46.00	46.00	-	46.00	
AKZO Ind [5]	2894.50	2835.50	2894.00	2902.30	2820.10	31.50	389.25	2649.05	34	2837.50	
Alankrit [1]	7.55	7.91	7.81	8.09	7.71	33.55	1.80	7.50	-	7.55	
ALEM PHAR [2]	69.80	70.70	70.40	70.90	69.85	43.10	110.00	67.10	-	69.80	
ALEM PHAR [2]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
Allegiant Fin [5]	59.24	61.13	60.28	61.48	58.27	105.55	7.01	45.54	-	59.24	
Alivulife [5]	910.00	910.00	910.00	910.00	910.00	910.00	910.00	910.00	-	910.00	
Alivulife [5]	546.00	546.00	546.00	546.00	546.00	546.00	546.00	546.00	-	546.00	
ALKA ALMIN [2]	140.10	140.90	140.10	141.50	137.90	33.11	244.80	137.90	30	140.90	
Alcalargo Glo [2]	8.01	7.89	8.09	8.09	7.79	460.29	16.18	7.71	-	8.01	
Aldiag Tech [5]	77.65	78.80	78.20	79.80	77.40	20.36	108.00	77.00	-	77.65	
Aldiag Tech [5]	108.64	108.64	108.64	108.64	108.64	108.64	108.64	108.64	-	108.64	
AlliedBld [5]	450.10	451.45	455.95	459.00	442.00	33.67	1.96	88.00	279.00	-	450.10
AllTimePlas [5]	23.88	22.66	24.20	23.00	21.96	77.4	39.40	21.80	-	23.88	
AllTimePlas [5]	13.56	13.56	13.56	13.56	13.56	13.56	13.56	13.56	-	13.56	
Amag Med [5]	37.85	38.22	38.03	38.55	37.60	48.20	43.80	31.80	-	37.85	
AmarJat.Enr [5]	80.90	80.05	80.02	80.99	79.99	22.94	109.00	79.40	-	80.90	
Amber [5]	765.70	782.50	774.00	782.00	752.50	258.19	129.00	765.70	-	765.70	
AMBA COTTO [5]	14.75	14.75	14.75	14.75	14.75	14.75	14.75	14.75	-	14.75	
Ambuja Cement [5]	41.75	48.00	47.00	48.45	47.44	62.50	69.35	33	-	41.75	
Amrutnagar [5]	574.00	570.65	572.00	577.95	555.55	27.83	78.95	538.00	-	574.00	
Amrutnagar [5]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
AnandRathi [5]	49.00	49.15	49.40	50.15	48.80	24.02	79.45	49.00	-	49.00	
Anant Raj [2]	489.30	491.80	490.70	501.15	488.00	27.14	366.15	489.30	-	489.30	
Anant Raj [2]	130.39	140.00	140.00	141.33	136.38	32.58	20.10	102.72	-	130.39	
Anand Paper [5]	66.09	65.55	66.00	66.50	65.00	66.00	66.00	66.00	-	66.09	
Andhra Sugr [5]	73.10	74.77	73.60	75.25	73.60	22.80	87.99	63.27	-	73.10	
AngelOne [5]	22.15	22.46	22.30	22.58	22.10	74.22	62.22	32.00	21.52	-	22.15
AngelOne [5]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
AnteliosBio [5]	554.00	539.40	559.15	578.00	531.05	45.33	76.75	357.00	-	554.00	
AnteliosBio [5]	66.75	66.75	66.75	66.75	66.75	66.75	66.75	66.75	-	66.75	
AnteliosBio [5]	48.25	48.25	48.25	48.25	48.25	48.25	48.25	48.25	-	48.25	
Anup Eng [5]	149.00	146.10	150.00	154.00	144.00	9.09	363.05	144.00	-	149.00	
Anupam Ras. [5]	124.56	124.40	124.80	126.00	123.24	82.94	140.00	60.15	-	124.56	
Apd Ind [5]	100.22	100.70	101.00	105.00	101.00	12.66	1164.75	427.00	-	100.22	
Apd Ind [5]	35.40	36.35	35.25	36.95	35.45	69.54	48.40	19.50	36	36.30	
Apex [5]	20.34	20.63	20.14	20.39	19.96	194.7821.01	21.35	95.20	32	20.32	
APL Apollo [2]	217.10	216.30	212.60	216.55	219.10	39.81	320.00	136.50	142	216.30	
APL Apollo [2]	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	129.70	-	129.70	
Apollo Hosp [5]	766.00	775.00	770.00	785.00	763.00	44.58	809.00	601.95	77	776.55	
Apollo Piles [5]	35.25	34.80	35.30	35.65	34.25	36.85	167.19	49.40	25.00	35.25	
Apollo Tyres [1]	43.10	44.45	43.50	44.65	43.05	40.83	204.02	54.30	25.00	43.10	
Apollo Tyres [1]	129.70	129.70	129.70								

The closing price is the average of the trade price(s) for the last half an hour/52-Week High/Low figures are in \$SE.

of these face value other than \$10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

ty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

he PE(Price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

he PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

company	Pr	Ci	Company	Pr	Ci	Company	Pr	Ci
22.66	22.29		TECS Network	546.20	492.45	Visshal Bat [5]	20.41	20.78
130.40	511.22		Tenereco	49.60	540.25	VishalMega [1]	10.41	11.04
PEL Sem Sys	137.00	140.00	TGS Strac	82.68	68.48	VL-e-Govm	15.07	14.91
0.42	14.08		Thinklink Pte [1]	0.15	0.18	Waaree Enr	2632.55	2646.05
0.55	0.57		Tisk Pvt	0.84	0.86	Waaree Re. [2]	806.56	815.00
0.26	0.25		Timex Group [1]	271.55	273.00	WardwinJnn [1]	6.24	6.77
12.65	12.75		Titan Biotec [2]	253.75	256.50	Waterbase	47.06	47.07
129.20	1.29		Titan Int'l [1]	0.57	0.82	Welcure Drug [1]	35.20	36.06
425.35	429.60		TMS	520.60	649.60	Wesps Spsl [6]	0.32	0.37
0.46	0.47		Transrail [1]	0.120	0.135	WPL [1]	391.65	392.00
0.83	8.53		Trifton Corp. [2]	51.00	51.25	Xtghlobal [1]	34.15	36.83
0.21	0.21		Triton Corp.	2763.70	2787.95	Yamini Int'l [1]	0.65	0.68
135.60	166.75		Ultramarine [2]	102.60	104.70	Yatharth Hsp	664.05	653.30
165.30	167.45		Unicom.eso[1]	100.65	100.35	Yatra Online [1]	117.05	120.00
125.75	125.75		Union [1]	0.99	0.95	Zaggle Pte [1]	215.45	217.20
197.70	291.80		Urban Asset	106.00	107.95	Zee [1]	11.30	11.84
181.70	180.10		UTI Comp	96.55	98.95	Zerodha Mutual	9.82	9.88
297.60	298.20		Utkashi SFB	131.20	131.08	Group T		
15.74	16.15		Valiant Comm	10.62	10.84			
17.50	17.50		Varrco Eng [1]	514.90	511.00			
24.12	22.05		Vedant Pts [1]	371.70	386.45			
125.70	125.70		Veeram Sec [2]	102.50	102.70			
124.70	120.98		Vidya Wires L	51.18	52.45			
171.20	171.20		Vikas Life [1]	1.38	1.36			
319.20	321.70		Vikram Solar	25.60	24.47			
57.00	58.50		Vital Eng [1]	63.60	64.03			
57.00	58.50		Vivanta Corp	13.46	13.810			
470.80	480.40		Vintage Cos [1]	0.62	0.63			
1143.25	1153.65		Visiona Fin [1]	0.35	0.33			
114.20	1140.65		Vista Pvt	41.84	41.72			

NSE Trade for Trade

company	Pr	Ci	Company	Pr	Ci	Company	Pr	Ci
uri Grow In	0.24	0.23	GE POWER	437.25	450.25	RIL COM V [5]	0.78	0.78
GR ENERGY	294.20	309.50	GVK pwr inf [1]	67.85	68.55	Schneider [2]	832.75	874.35
Rightmint[Co]	9.69	9.78	Izmo Ltd	20.69	26.35	SHREE RAM TV	67.83	64.34
Rightmint [Co]	9.69	9.78	JAPRA [2]	2.50	2.47	Swan&Berg Hst	1870.00	1937.20
MAUSAMY DEV	57.42	56.35	MadhavCopper	76.60	69.96	SUS SUPPLY CH	110.50	111.94
MAUSAMY IFT N	78.08	75.80	REL INFRA	85.04	90.09			

NSE Trade for Trade

[illegible]